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Literature review

Dr. P. Ganeshkumar
MD

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Why perform literature review?

- Saves yourself from work!
- Know the subject matter better
- Suggest new research topics, questions & methods

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Lit review : Not just a summary

Information seeking

Scan the literature efficiently using manual or computerized methods to identify a set of potentially useful articles and books

Critical appraisal

the ability to apply principles of analysis to identify those studies which are unbiased and valid.

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Lit review: Organized search

Identify lacunae
As appears in the literature

Develop questions for further research

Organize information
relate it to the research question

Synthesize results
summary of what is and isn't known

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Information retrieval

identifying, within a large document collection, a subset of documents whose content is most relevant to user's need

Database organization (database management)

Structure of query (user defined)

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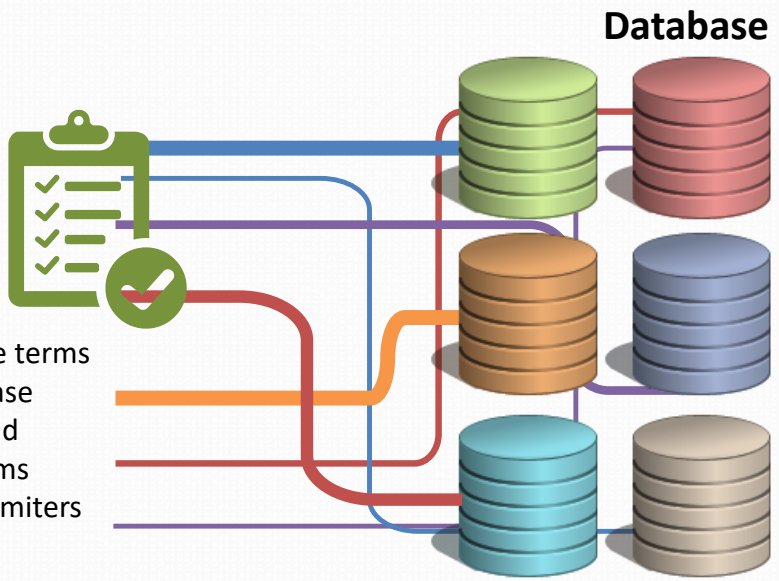
Database structure and management



Indexing

- Cover all the terms in the database
- Common and frequent terms
- Used as delimiters

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Appropriate place to search

General info
- HON certified sites
- Web Search Engines – Google

Systematic reviews/
Meta-analysis / EBMs
- Cochrane Library
- Map of Medicine etc

Specific query
- PubMed / Scopus / Google Scholar database etc

Archived full text articles
- Free Open Access
- Fee Based – From Libraries

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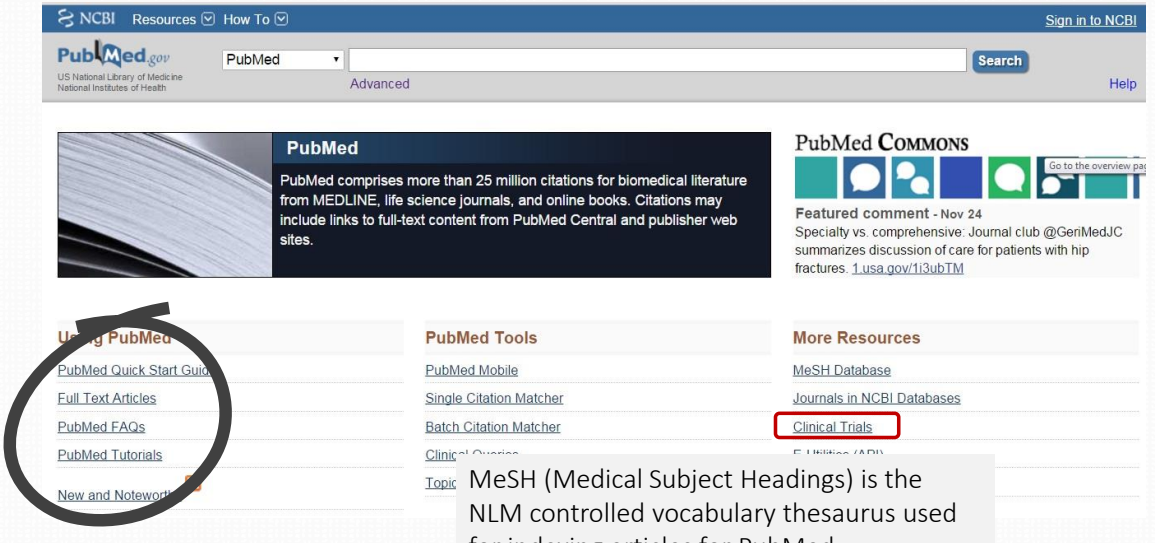
Pubmed (http://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pubmed)



MeSH (Medical Subject Headings) is the NLM controlled vocabulary thesaurus used for indexing articles for PubMed.

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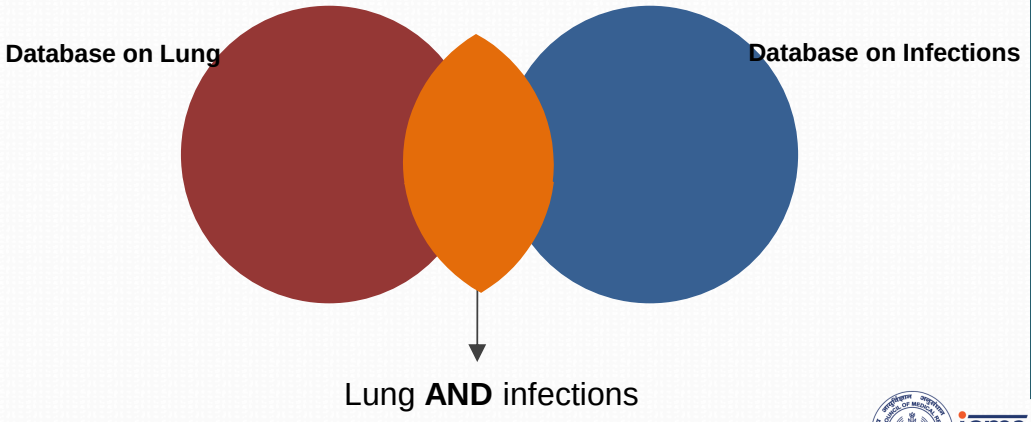
Searching a database

- Boolean query: AND /OR/NOT



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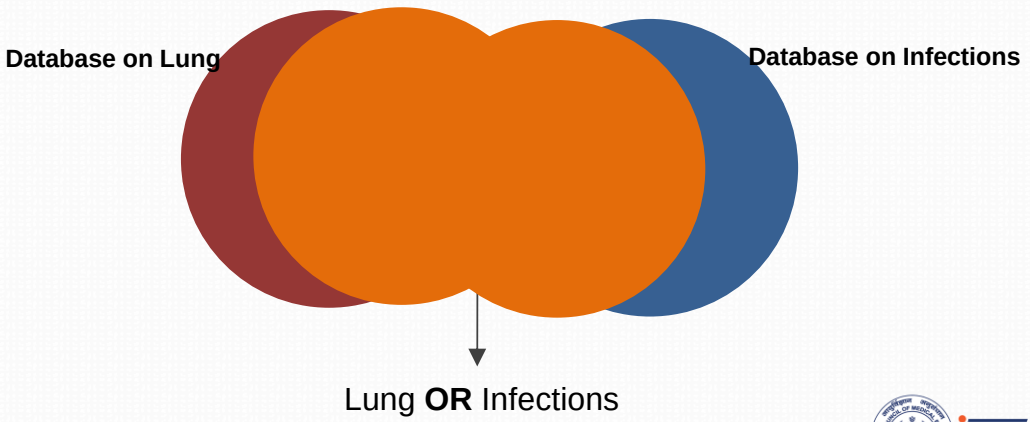

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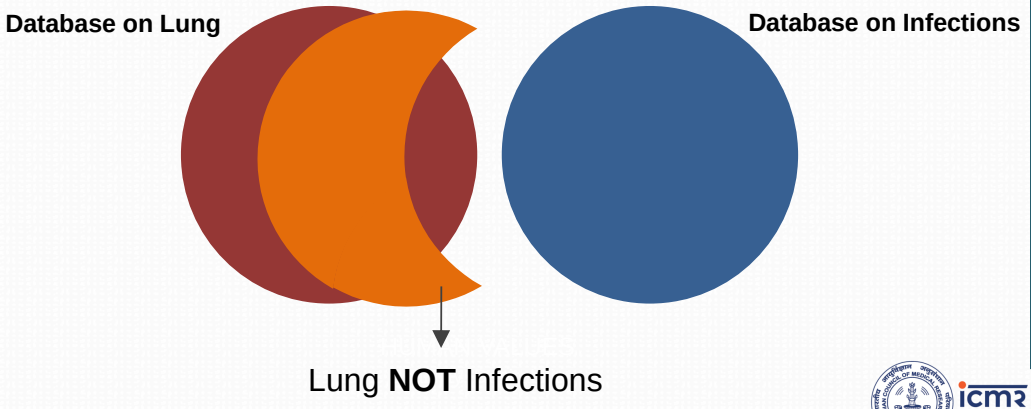

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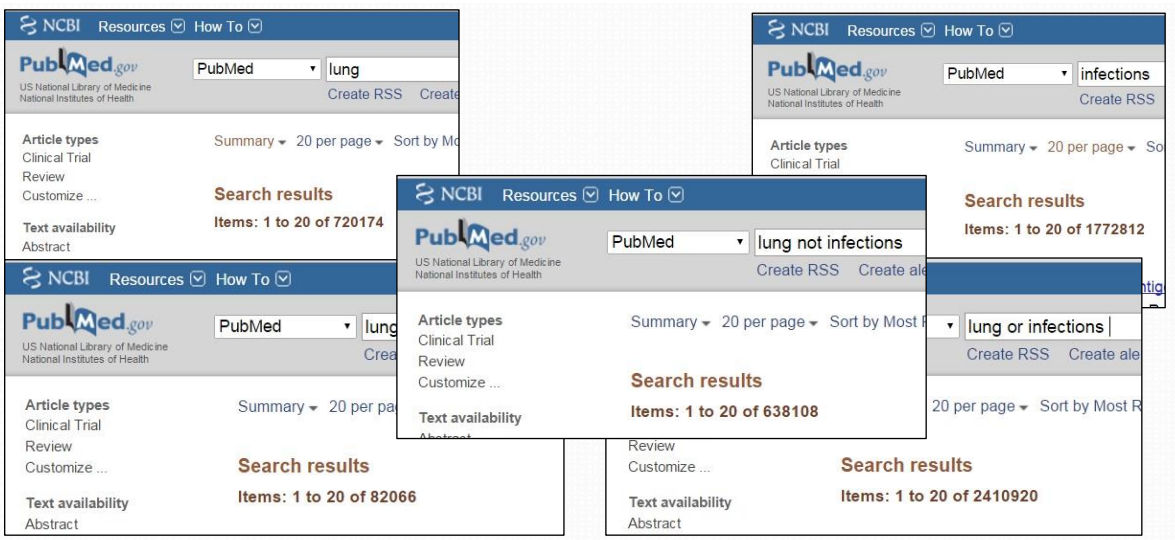

Searching Pubmed : Boolean query

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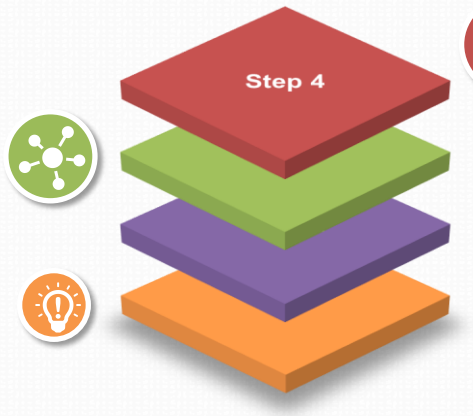
Selecting studies :for Literature review



Tabulate info from each study & Compare

Compare methods, results, findings etc

Select those of good quality

Read and critique studies

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Example table of literature

Citation	Design	Objectives	Study population	Sample size	Measurable outcome & results	Authors Conclusion

Chronologically placed
RECENT

PAST

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Writing a literature review

1. Introduction
   - Purpose of review
   - Organization of review
   - Basis for ordering
   - Most important to least
   - Earliest to most recent
2. Empirical literature
   - Includes quality studies relevant to topic
   - Explain each study using paraphrasing rather than direct quotes
   - Scholarly, but brief, critique of study's strengths and weaknesses
3. Summary
   - Concise presentation of the research knowledge about a selected topic—what is known and not known

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Ethical Issues

- Content from studies - presented honestly and - not distorted
- Weaknesses of a study - addressed ; not necessary to be highly critical
- Sources should be accurately documented

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Thank you

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